AHLI SWITZLER | CASE STUDY 2

Taste Is the Job: An AI-Drafted Essay, Verified Line by Line

I wrote a research essay on where marketing is headed with Claude as a drafting partner, then checked every source and claim until the argument held up without the AI's help.

THE CHALLENGE

Argue a position on marketing's future with academic evidence, using AI to draft, without letting it fill gaps with claims I couldn't defend or sources that didn't say what it said they did.

ROLE AND TOOLS

Solo. Claude with live web search, plus a style constraint list I wrote to keep out the phrasing that marks text as machine-written.

THE ARGUMENT

The shift runs two ways at once. On the production side, AI makes the referenceable moves cheap, so judgment and originality become what firms pay for. On the discovery side, AI summaries break the click: Pew found people click a result 8% of the time with a summary versus 15% without. The game moves from winning a rank to earning a citation. Production rewards work a model wouldn't have generated, and discovery rewards work a model can read and cite.

THE PROCESS

1. A first prompt set the AI's role, my position, my own work as evidence, and the style constraints.
2. When the draft covered only production, I asked for a discovery section built on SEO versus AIO, with sources.
3. I worked paragraph by paragraph: I stated what I thought each study found, and had the AI confirm or correct me against the source. About 23 rounds of instruction and correction.
4. I asked the AI to tell me where my own position was biased.
5. A final pass checked every source for academic use.

WHAT I CAUGHT AND DECIDED

- Three overstatements in my own argument. Paid search is moving inside AI answers, where about 26% of ChatGPT responses now carry ads. The generational move to chatbots is partial, since traditional search still leads in every age group. And how often chatbots cite any source varies widely by industry. I wrote all three into the essay as concessions.
- Several opinion-driven trade articles that I replaced with peer-reviewed studies.
- Language that oversold the case. I rewrote about 13 passages.

THE RESULT

A nine-page APA paper across seven full versions, landing on a position the evidence supports: discovery is being repriced. The written analysis of the process documents every prompt.

FROM THE PROMPT LOG

> Okay so I am realizing that in this essay I only cover the from end work of content creation and marketers use of AI is changing but I haven't touched on the fact that on the customer facing aspect of AI. We just learned in class about SEO vs AIO optimization, and the now conversion of the very dominant google search engine (of paying to be the top spot on the first page of google, Need a source for this because I know this information but it should have been reported on by forbes) into a AI assisted search engine has pretty much made that a bit outdated while young people are moving toward claude or open AI as their new way to get knowledge. Please let me know where I am being Bias in this but I know this is a common thought amongst marketers and I also believe this claim that we will have to also be aware that though our workflows can make our marketing roles easier and more creative we also still need to relearn how to be effectively found through this new system of discovery.

Asking for the discovery section, and for the AI to point out where my position was biased.

Assessment: 100/100. Christina J. Inge, EdD, Harvard Extension School, Digital Marketing and Artificial Intelligence.